Newsletter February 2024

Dear Members, Supporters, Patrons and Friends

We hope you are all well.

It has been almost a year since the last newsletter from LKB was issued. Apologies for the long silence but the trustees have been occupied with dealing with a number of issues that has proved to be rather time consuming.

Since then we hosted an open day as our newly-renovated LKB headquarters in July 2023, staged a Narayan puja in September 2023 at 18 Byron Road, and hosted our annual Kalipuja with our new 5ft-tall protima centre-stage at Harrow Arts Centre in November 2023.

We also reluctantly had to see one of LKB's most pro-active members and fundraisers, Mrs Jayati Das, step down as secretary and trustee as she had served the maximum number of consecutive terms allowed.

We have also welcomed on board two new trustees, Mr Shivaji Ghosh and Mrs Rubi Bhattacharyya.

The repair and renovation of LKB's headquarters at 18/20 Byron Road continued throughout 2023 and into 2024.

UPDATE ON DAMAGE CAUSED TO 18/20 BYRON ROAD, HARROW

While the majority of repair/renovation work at LKB's permanent home of 18/20 Byron Road was completed in the first half of 2023, some repairs remain pending due to water continuing to leak into the property from above.

Last October, the owners of the one of the first-floor flats blocked our builder from replacing the flat roof over the room used for distributing food – and this work is still pending as the weather needs to be dry for this work to be carried out.

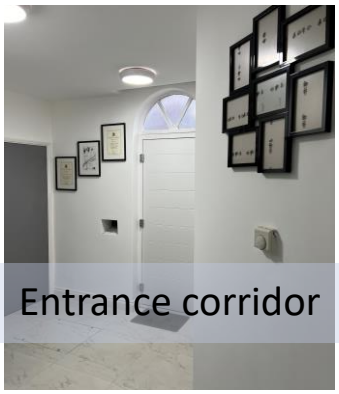
The renovation was carried out by a team of builders/plumbers/electricians/painters headed by **John Tiganescu**. We are extremely grateful for the time and effort he has put into this project because what should have been a 3-4 month assignment has dragged on for over a year due to the obstacles he has faced from various sources.

John also kindly sourced dozens of cushioned chairs at an extremely competitive price to replace the old plastic ones we had inherited from the previous owners of the building.

John can be contacted on 07717 210668 for any building works.

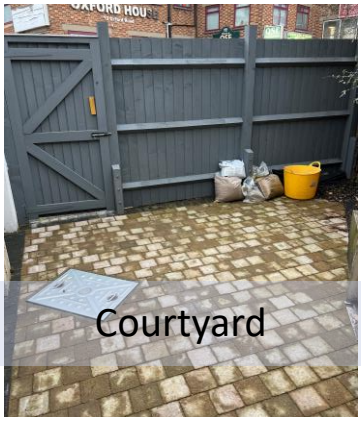
We attach a few photographs to illustrate the renovation work carried out.


Puja room entrance


Entrance corridor


Puja room


Back room


Courtyard


Main hall

LKB SECRETARY, MRS JAYATI DAS, STEPPED DOWN AS TRUSTEE

We would like to offer our heartfelt thanks to Mrs Jayati Das for her decades of service to LKB. Mrs Das stepped down as a trustee/secretary at the 2023 AGM because the terms of the constitution state that a trustee can serve a maximum of three consecutive terms.

During her tenure as trustee/secretary, Mrs Das has raised thousands of pounds for LKB by actively chasing her contacts and has found much-needed sponsors for the staging of LKB events. She has also been an enthusiastic and pro-active organiser of various LKB events, be it in our headquarters or hired premises.

Behind the scenes she helped with a multitude of everyday tasks that were required to ensure the smooth running of our charity, which included balancing the accounts following community/fund-raising events, liaising with representatives of other organisations, writing minutes at our trustee meetings/AGM etc.

Despite stepping down from the board, Mrs Das remains an integral part of our core support group and continues to help LKB by carrying out a number of tasks. The trustees are grateful for her continued support.

WELCOMING TWO NEW TRUSTEES AND RE-ELECTION

We were delighted to welcome two new trustees to LKB, Mr Shivaji Ghosh and Mrs Rubi Bhattacharyya who were elected on to the board during the 2023 AGM. They will join existing trustees, Dr Satya Chatterjee, Mr Debabrata Dey, Mrs Rama Choudhury and Miss Pritha Sarkar in looking after the running of LKB.

As Mrs Das stepped down as secretary, Miss Sarkar was elected to take over that role.

2023 LKB EVENTS, INCLUDING KALIPUJA AT HARROW ARTS CENTRE

With LKB's premises being closed to the public for three years due to the pandemic and then because of the damage caused to the ground floor premises due to water leaking in from above, we finally managed to welcome our patrons and supporters for an open day at our newly renovated premises on 15 July 2023.

We also hosted a Narayan puja that was kindly sponsored by two of our patrons on 10 September 2023.

It was lovely to see so many familiar faces at our annual Kalipuja held at Harrow Arts Centre on 12 November 2023. We had close to 400 devotees attending.

Puja, with our new 5-feet-tall protima centre stage, was officiated by our regular priest Mr Robin Roy.

The trustees would like to thank everyone who helped to make the event successful, including transportation of new protima to and from Harrow Arts Centre (Tanuj Ghosh and Shantanu Dutta Gupta), decorate protima and the stage (Suhana Basu Roy, her mother Millie Basu Roy and Rubi Bhattacharyya), distribute/serve food (Susmita Dey and her children Debayan and Debosmita + Sanchita Ghosh and her daughters Dakshayani and Devashree), cooking bhog (Dipti Chatterjee), assisting the priest in puja arrangements (Lina Das).

We would also like to thank Vikram Roy, Shivaji Ghosh, Ujjal Bongo, Debjani Sengupta, Bulbul Roy and Ankita Das for their help in carrying out miscellaneous tasks and all the volunteers who helped to set up the venue, arrange/distribute prasad and finally clear up the venue at the end of the day. The assistance given is greatly appreciated because without this help it would have been impossible to stage the puja successfully.

Please forgive us if we have forgotten to mention anyone by name as many people assisted on the day.

Following the retirement of our long-time caterer Dipak Sharma, we handed the responsibility to Namaste Mumbai, who produced a delicious spread for all those present.

Our trustees/support group members Rama Choudhury, Jayati Das, Debabrata Dey and Dipiti Chatterjee worked tirelessly before, during and after the puja to ensure the event was enjoyed by all those in attendance.

UNAUTHROISED FILMING OF ANNUAL KALIPUJA

A number of LKB supporters/patrons were extremely unhappy when it came to light that the annual Kalipuja at Harrow Arts Centre was broadcast on an Indian news channel, especially since the report contained a number of factual errors. The person interviewed in this report is not an LKB trustee and did not seek prior permission from any LKB office bearer about filming the event. This recording had not been authorised by any LKB office bearer.

The trustees have written a letter to the person behind this report and have instructed him to ensure the report is removed from ABP Ananda's website and any other social media platforms.

If our instructions are not followed in a timely manner, we would appreciate any help with those with a legal background to help pursue this matter.

RE-OPENING OF LKB HEADQUARTERS FOR COMMUNITY EVENTS, LUNCHEON CLUB

Once the renovation work has been completed, we look forward to throwing open our doors again for community events within our premises, resuming the weekly luncheon club and holding other activities for our community.

APPEAL TO SPONSOR LKB EVENTS/CATERING AT LKB EVENTS

Due to rising costs, our food bill was quite expensive for last year's annual Kalipuja and unfortunately we are now in danger of not being able to cover our costs at future events.

Hence we would like to request supporters/patrons to donate more generously or even consider sponsoring the catering at such events.

We are hoping to stage 4-5 pujas/community events during 2024 at our Byron Road premises in addition to the main Kalipuja at Harrow Arts Centre - hence we are appealing our patrons/supporters to sponsor these events.



RENTAL OF LKB PREMISES AT BYRON ROAD

In order to raise much needed funds for our charitable activities, rooms within 18/20 Byron Road will be available to hire when they are not in use for LKB events.
The hourly rates are as follows:

Rental rate in 2024 of big room, big cloakroom, kitchen and second room with access to enclosed courtyard will be £50.00 per hour + two hours cleaning charges. Cleaning deposit will be refunded if no cleaning is required once keys are handed back to LKB.

Rental rate in 2024 for smaller room (which has door opening to Byron Road) with attached small cloakroom will be £30 per hour + one hour cleaning charges. Cleaning deposit will be refunded if no cleaning is required

LKB will issue an invoice to anyone interested in hiring premises and **all charges will need to be paid in advance. If payment is made by cheque, funds need to be cleared in LKB's account before premises are made available.**

HONOURING LKB FOUNDERS AND TRUSTEE BOARD MEMBERS

As mentioned in our previous newsletters, we are also planning to revamp the LKB website and include sections honouring:

1. The **founders** of LKB
2. All those who held **elected positions** on the board of trustees
3. Non-trustees who have made **notable contributions** to LKB

Hence we would greatly appreciate if people could submit contributions to any LKB trustee/core group supporter.

To keep the process streamlined, we would like only **two-paragraph contributions on each person** – ie one paragraph should be on their background and one paragraph on their contribution to LKB.

Contributions can also be emailed to: **kalibarilondon@gmail.com**



UPDATING LKB MAILING LIST AND MEETING GDPR REQUIREMENTS

Your privacy is important to us and we would like to communicate with you about LKB and its activities. **To do so we need your consent. If you object to any of the following, then please let us know at kalibarilondon@gmail.com and we will remove your details from our database.**

From 25 May 2018 the new General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) gives an individual more control over how their personal information is used. A brief explanation is given below on what data about you we use and your rights.

1. LKB keeps your individual data such as your name, postal address and email address only for the purpose of informing you about forthcoming events of LKB. We do not share your data with any other organisations or individuals.

2. You can at any time withdraw your consent, view the information kept about you and ask to delete part or all of the information on you.

3. You can lodge a complaint about misuse of information by speaking to one of the trustees.

We look forward to seeing you all soon and thank you for your continuing support.

Best wishes

LKB Trustees: Dr Satya Chatterjee, Mr Debabrata Dey, Mrs Rama Choudhury, Miss Pritha Sarkar, Mr Shivaji Ghosh and Mrs Rubi Bhattacharyya